EMPIRICISM

EXPERIENTIAL ORIGIN OF SIMPLE CONTENT -> LOCKEAN REPRESENTATIVE REALISM -> BERKELEYAN IMMATERIALISM -> HUMEAN NATURAL BELIEF AND MITIGATED SCEPTICISM

Read the numbered rail from Stage 00 to the final synthesis at Stage 22. Each stage uses a layout chosen for its own content - timelines for sequences, matrices for comparisons, dialectic panels for objection-reply-residual work. The grey E card is optional enrichment and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW
● SUBORDINATE EXTRA
● APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • repaired in place; prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00

EMPIRICIST RULE AND THE LOCKE-BERKELEY-HUME PRESSURE SEQUENCE

EVERY SIMPLE CONTENT TRACES TO EXPERIENCE
SENSATION + REFLECTION
IMPRESSIONS + IDEAS
OPERATIONS NOT DENIED
REPRESENTATIVE REALISM
IMMATERIALISM
MITIGATED SCEPTICISM
FOUR PRINTED TEST CASES

SHARED RULE: every simple content traces to sensation, reflection or impression → LOCKE: ideas represent an unknowable material world; substratum is 'know not what' → BERKELEY: an idea can be like only an idea, so matter is meaningless, not unknown → HUME: no impression of substance, self or necessary connexion; custom and natural belief → ENDPOINT: mitigated scepticism, and the diagnosis Kant takes up

THE SHARED RULE

- Every SIMPLE cognitive content traces to experience: Locke's outer SENSATION and inner REFLECTION; Hume's IMPRESSIONS.
- Never denied: comparing, combining and abstracting, nor Hume's a priori relations of ideas.
- Denied: innate IDEAS and PRINCIPLES in Locke's target sense.

THE ADDED PREMISE AT EACH STEP

- LOCKE adds RESEMBLANCE: ideas of primary qualities picture their causes.
- BERKELEY adds COMPARABILITY: an idea can be like nothing but an idea (Principles Sec.8).
- HUME adds the ATOMISM OF IMPRESSIONS: no relation is given with its terms.

THE FOUR SYLLABUS TEST CASES

- 1 Theory of Knowledge; 2 Substance and Qualities; 3 Self and God; 4 Scepticism.
- Corpus signal: 12 primary-owned parts of 112 Western parts, 2018-2025, with at least one in every year.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Each successor removes an exemption his predecessor had quietly granted, so the slide measures consistency rather than decline.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Empiricism is one rule about the origin of content enforced with rising severity, not three biographies sharing a chapter.

01

STAGE 01

LOCKE AGAINST INNATE IDEAS: THREE GROUNDS AND THE SURVIVING INNATISM

UNIVERSAL ASSENT FAILS
NO UNCONSCIOUS IDEAS
GENETIC ACCOUNT AVAILABLE
REDUNDANCY
DISPOSITIONAL REPLY
EXCEPT THE INTELLECT ITSELF

CLAIM: some ideas are stamped on the mind at birth → GROUND 1: universal assent fails → GROUND 2: nothing can be in the mind unperceived → GROUND 3: experience already explains every candidate → REPLACEMENT: 'white paper, void of all characters' (Essay II.i.2)

THE THREE GROUNDS, BOOK I

- GROUND 1 universal assent fails: children and the cognitively impaired lack the alleged content.
- GROUND 2 DECISIVE: a thought the mind does not think is self-contradictory, since to be in the mind is to be perceived by it.
- GROUND 3 redundancy: every candidate idea can be traced to sensation or reflection, so innateness is idle.

THE REPLY LOCKE MUST FACE

- Descartes: innate ideas are CAPACITIES elicited on an occasion, as a family disease is innate before it appears.
- Grounds 1 and 3 are empirical and can be absorbed; the weight falls entirely on ground 2.

ADJUDICATION

- Naive innatism of consciously possessed inborn propositions: destroyed.
- Dispositional innatism: survives, because ground 2 is a stipulation about the meaning of 'idea'.
- Leibniz names the survivor - nothing in the intellect that was not in the senses, EXCEPT THE INTELLECT ITSELF.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The refutation succeeds by redundancy rather than by impossibility, so structural innatism escapes and Kant later vindicates it.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Locke shows innateness to be unnecessary, not impossible, and the whole weight rests on what 'in the mind' is taken to mean.

02

STAGE 02

SOURCES OF IDEAS: SENSATION, REFLECTION AND THE WORKMANSHIP OF THE UNDERSTANDING

SENSATION - OUTER SENSE
REFLECTION - INNER SENSE
SIMPLE IDEAS PASSIVE
COMPLEX IDEAS ACTIVE
MODES
SUBSTANCES
RELATIONS

EXPERIENCE IN TWO CHANNELS

SENSATION: outer objects acting on the senses → REFLECTION: the mind observing its own operations → SIMPLE IDEAS received passively, then combined, compared and abstracted

TWO FOUNTAINS

- SENSATION supplies colour, sound, taste, smell, warmth, solidity, extension, figure, motion and number.
- REFLECTION supplies ideas of thinking, doubting, believing, willing, reasoning and knowing.
- Omitting reflection reduces Locke to crude sensationalism and loses the account of logic, mathematics and the self.

THE THREE COMPLEX KINDS

- MODES: dependent combinations such as triangle, gratitude or number.
- SUBSTANCES: supposed independent bearers represented through clusters of co-occurring qualities.
- RELATIONS: ideas produced by comparing one thing with another, such as cause or identity.

THE PAYLOAD MOST SCRIPTS MISS

- 'Substance' appears here as a COMPLEX IDEA: a cluster plus a supposition, never an inspected substratum.
- Blank page denies innate CONTENT, not activity; only simple ideas are passively received.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Experience supplies the stock while the understanding supplies the workmanship, which is why classification is ours and not nature's.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The mind supplies the workmanship and experience supplies the stock, so an idea's origin becomes the test of its legitimacy.

03

STAGE 03

KNOWLEDGE, THE THREE DEGREES AND THE DOMAIN OF PROBABILITY

AGREEMENT OF IDEAS
INTUITIVE
DEMONSTRATIVE
SENSITIVE - WEAKEST
PROBABILITY AND JUDGEMENT
NARROW CERTIFICATION

DEGREE	MECHANISM	EXAMPLE	CERTAINTY
INTUITIVE	agreement seen immediately, with no intervening idea	'white is not black'; my own existence	highest
DEMONSTRATIVE	agreement seen through a chain of intervening ideas	mathematical proof; the existence of God	high, but long chains can err
SENSITIVE	the existence of particular things now affecting the senses	'there is a sheet of paper before me'	lowest of the three
PROBABILITY	judgement on conformity with experience and on testimony	natural history, analogy, everyday expectation	not knowledge at all

THE DEFINITION AND ITS COST

- Knowledge is the perception of the agreement or disagreement of IDEAS.
- Everything about the world must therefore be stated as a relation among ideas, which is why external existence is hardest to certify.

BELOW THE KNOWLEDGE LINE

- Probability and judgement govern testimony, analogy, natural history and everyday expectation.
- Testimony is weighed by number, integrity, skill and consistency.
- Unresolved: sensitive knowledge and high probability shade into one another without a sharp boundary.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Rich sources combined with narrow certification place the external world on the weakest rung and open the sceptical challenge.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Locke is generous about where ideas come from and severe about what may be called knowledge, and that asymmetry does the damage.

04

STAGE 04

REPRESENTATIVE REALISM, THE VEIL OBJECTION AND WHAT SURVIVES IT

IDEAS REPRESENT OBJECTS
VEIL OF PERCEPTION
INVOLUNTARINESS
INTER-SENSORY AGREEMENT
DIVINE NON-DECEPTION
STRUCTURAL REPRESENTATION SURVIVES

THE CHAIN AND THE CLAIM

- Body acts on sense organ, which produces the IDEA - the only item ever inspected.
- Ideas of primary qualities are said to RESEMBLE their causes; ideas of secondary qualities resemble nothing.

THE OBJECTION AND FOUR DEFENCES

- OBJECTION: the comparison of idea with unperceived cause can never in principle be made.
- DEFENCE 1 sense ideas are involuntary; DEFENCE 2 different senses agree about one body.
- DEFENCE 3 pleasure and pain accompany real bodies; DEFENCE 4 God would not systematically deceive us.

RESIDUAL AFTER THE REPLY

- SURVIVES: a causal and structural representation claim.
- EXPOSED: the qualitative resemblance claim, which is the exact target of Principles Sec.8.
- 'Veil of perception' is the critics' image, not Locke's phrase.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The theory certifies only relations among ideas, so its own standard cannot verify the resemblance it asserts.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Berkeley's later objection is not an external attack but a demand that Locke apply his own standard to his own thesis.

05

STAGE 05

ABSTRACTION: THE EIGHT-STEP ARGUMENT AND THE GENERAL REPRESENTATIVE

ALL EXISTENTS PARTICULAR
WORDS SIGNIFY GENERAL IDEAS
SEPARATION FROM TIME AND PLACE
GENERAL REPRESENTATIVE
CONCEPTUALISM
WORKMANSHIP OF THE UNDERSTANDING

PARTICULAR IDEA of this triangle, this dog, this man → STRIP circumstances of time, place and every concomitant idea → RESULT: a GENERAL REPRESENTATIVE of all particulars of the sort → ANNEXED to a sortal name it becomes the NOMINAL ESSENCE we classify by

THE NUMBERED SPINE

- III.iii.1 everything that exists is particular; III.iii.2-4 separate names for each are impossible.
- III.iii.6 words are general only by signifying general ideas; III.iii.6-9 ideas become general by separation.
- III.iii.15 the abstract idea annexed to a sortal name IS the nominal essence.
- III.iii.11 universals are 'the inventions and creatures of the understanding' and concern only signs.

WHY IT IS NOT OPTIONAL

- Without abstraction Locke has no account of classification, definition or the nominal essences of Book III.
- Berkeley therefore attacks abstraction FIRST, in the Introduction, before a word about matter.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Generality is placed inside the idea rather than inside the use of the word, and that placement is what Berkeley later attacks.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Classification for Locke is the workmanship of the understanding rather than a reading-off of nature's own divisions.

06

STAGE 06

NOMINAL AND REAL ESSENCE, THE TRIANGLE CONCESSION AND FOUR PRESUPPOSITIONS

NOMINAL ESSENCE KNOWN
REAL ESSENCE UNKNOWN
ALL AND NONE AT ONCE
IMPERFECT, CANNOT EXIST
PARTIAL NOT CONTRADICTORY
IDEATIONAL MEANING

	NOMINAL ESSENCE	REAL ESSENCE
WHAT IT IS	the abstract idea annexed to a general name	the internal constitution producing observable properties
EXAMPLE	gold = yellow, heavy, malleable, soluble in aqua regia	the arrangement of insensible corpuscles
EPISTEMIC STATUS	KNOWN, because we made it	UNKNOWN, because we merely posit it
FUNCTION	fixes classification into sorts	fixes nothing we can actually use

THE CONCESSION AT IV.vii.9

- The general triangle 'must be neither oblique nor rectangle, neither equilateral, equicrural, nor scalenon; but all and none of these at once'.
- Locke calls it 'something imperfect, that cannot exist'; Berkeley quotes the passage verbatim at Principles Intro Sec.13.

FOUR PRESUPPOSITIONS

- P1 meaning is IDEATIONAL; P2 ideas are IMAGISTIC; P3 mental SUBTRACTION leaves content; P4 ONE IDEA PER GENERAL WORD.
- Berkeley destroys P2 and P3; Wittgenstein later destroys P1 and P4.

BEST REPLY AND ITS PRICE

- REPLY: the abstract idea is PARTIAL, with the angles left undetermined, not CONTRADICTORY with angles assigned.
- PRICE: the abstract idea stops being imagistic and is no longer an 'idea' in Locke's official sense.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Berkeley defeats the imagistic Locke and loses to the determinable Locke, so the true casualty is the ideational theory of meaning.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The dispute over abstraction is decided by what an idea is taken to be, which is why its heir is Wittgenstein rather than Hume.

07

STAGE 07

PRIMARY AND SECONDARY QUALITIES: TWO SEPARABLE THESES UNDER TWO ATTACKS

SOLIDITY EXTENSION FIGURE MOTION NUMBER
COLOUR SOUND TASTE SMELL WARMTH
POWERS, NOT ILLUSIONS
PARITY ARGUMENT
LIKENESS PRINCIPLE
ISOMORPHISM RESCUE

AXIS	PRIMARY QUALITIES	SECONDARY QUALITIES
LIST	solidity, extension, figure, motion or rest, number	colour, sound, taste, smell, warmth or cold
STATUS	really in the object and inseparable from body	POWERS to produce sensations in a perceiver
OUR IDEAS	RESEMBLE the qualities themselves	resemble nothing whatever in the object
TEST	every fragment however small retains them	vary with the perceiver's sense-organs

TWO THESES, SEPARATED

- THESIS A the EXPLANATORY division: which properties a corpuscular physics must attribute to any body.
- THESIS B the RESEMBLANCE picture: ideas of primary qualities picture their causes.
- Cut the sugar cube to invisibility: shape survives the slicing, sweetness does not.

THE TWO ATTACKS ADJUDICATED

- PARITY (Sec.9-15) hits A: size varies with distance, motion with frame, shape with angle. ANSWER: relativity is exactly what a real shape produces.
- LIKENESS (Sec.8) hits B and LANDS: an unverifiable resemblance is empty.
- RESCUE: isomorphism - a map corresponds to terrain without being terrain-coloured.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Only the pictorial thesis falls, so the surviving distinction is between measurable-structural and response-dependent properties.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Locke's error was to rest the quality distinction on a picture rather than on explanatory role, which is why physics kept it and he lost it.

08

STAGE 08

THE SUBSTRATUM AND THE ROUTE FROM UNKNOWN MATTER TO MEANINGLESS MATTER

SOMETHING I KNOW NOT WHAT
EXPLANATORY POSIT
NATURE UNKNOWN
EXISTENCE NOT DENIED
BEING PLUS SUPPORTING
MEANINGLESS, NOT MYSTERIOUS

CLUSTERS THAT REGULARLY GO TOGETHER: yellow, heavy, malleable, soluble

WE CANNOT CONCEIVE QUALITIES SUBSISTING ALONE, so a support is supposed → NO IMPRESSION OF THE SUPPORT IS EVER PRESENTED to sense → BERKELEY: strip the metaphor and only an abstract general idea remains

LOCKE'S EXACT CLAIM

- Essay II.xxiii.2: 'a supposition of he knows not what support of such qualities'.
- DENIED: any positive idea of the substratum and any knowledge of the real essence.
- AFFIRMED: that something is qualified, since qualities do not float.

BERKELEY'S DISSOLUTION

- 'Support' is a dead metaphor from pillars and floors.
- Strip it and what remains is the abstract idea of BEING plus the relative notion of SUPPORTING - an abstract general idea.
- So immaterialism RESTS ON the nominalism, and matter is meaningless rather than unknown.

FIX THE THREE POSITIONS BY THEIR VERBS

- LOCKE SUPPOSES a support whose nature is unknown.
- BERKELEY DENIES THE SENSE of the expression 'material substance'.
- HUME DISSOLVES substance into a stable bundle, and does so for spiritual substance as well.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — An unknowable support is itself an abstract general idea, so the attack on abstraction removes matter without a separate argument.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Locke denies knowledge of substance's nature and never its existence, and that precise limit is what Berkeley converts into meaninglessness.

09

STAGE 09

PERSONAL IDENTITY: CRITERION, CASE, OBJECTIONS AND THE REPAIRED ACCOUNT

PERSON, MAN, SUBSTANCE
CONTINUITY OF CONSCIOUSNESS
APPROPRIATION
FORENSIC CONCEPT
PRINCE AND COBBLER
BRAVE OFFICER
OVERLAPPING CHAINS

THE CRITERION

- II.xxvii.9, chapter ADDED IN THE SECOND EDITION OF 1694: a person is a thinking intelligent being that can consider itself as itself in different times and places.
- Identity extends as far as present consciousness can APPROPRIATE a past thought or action; memory is vehicle and evidence, not the definition.
- PRINCE AND COBBLER: the person who wakes is the prince, the man who wakes is the cobbler.

THE OBJECTIONS

- BUTLER and REID: memory presupposes identity, so the definition is circular.
- REID'S BRAVE OFFICER: the officer remembers the boy and the general the officer, but not the boy - transitivity fails.
- GAPS: dreamless sleep, anaesthesia and amnesia interrupt consciousness.

REPAIRS AND RESIDUAL

- Overlapping chains restore transitivity by making identity the ancestral of direct appropriation.
- Continuous CAPACITY for appropriation answers the gaps without requiring constant recollection.
- RESIDUAL: 'consciousness of it as mine' may re-import the ownership it was meant to constitute.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The repaired psychological-continuity reading survives Reid at the price of the simple episodic-memory criterion.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Locke's account is forensically indispensable and metaphysically incomplete, which is exactly what the directive to examine requires you to say.

10

STAGE 10

LOCKE'S DEMONSTRATIVE GOD AND THE CAUSAL PREMISE HUME WILL REFUSE

NOT INTUITIVE
NOT SENSITIVE
DEMONSTRATIVE - SECOND DEGREE
NOTHING COMES FROM NOTHING
ETERNAL MOST KNOWING BEING
NO INNATE IDEA OF GOD

THE CHAIN

- I exist, and I know it with intuitive certainty.
- Something cannot come from nothing.
- Therefore there has existed from eternity a most powerful and most knowing being.

PLACEMENT AND LIMIT

- A cosmological-style argument conducted inside an empiricist framework, above the external world and below self-knowledge.
- EXPOSED PREMISE: the causal principle, which Hume refuses to certify because no impression of necessity exists.
- Book I explicitly denies any innate idea of God, so the proof must be demonstrative.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Locke's proof of God fails exactly where Hume's analysis of causation bites, which is the cleanest link across the item.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: God is reached at Locke's second degree of knowledge, so the proof stands or falls with a causal principle he never certifies.

11

STAGE 11

BERKELEY'S ANTI-ABSTRACTION AND THE NOMINALIST REPLACEMENT

PARTS THAT COULD EXIST APART
ABSTRACTION PROPER DENIED
MADE TO STAND FOR
SELECTIVE ATTENTION
WORDS NEED NOT STAND FOR IDEAS
MATTER BECOMES MEANINGLESS

SEPARATION of what could exist apart is ALLOWED → SEPARATION of what cannot exist apart is IMPOSSIBLE → LOCKE'S TRIANGLE is self-contradictory, so no abstract idea can be framed → REPLACEMENT: a determinate particular idea MADE TO STAND FOR its sort → PAYLOAD: matter is the abstract idea of being plus a relative notion of supporting

WHAT IS CONCEDED AND WHAT IS DENIED

- CONCEDED: separating a hand from a body or a torso from a head, because such parts could exist apart.
- DENIED: extension without colour, motion without determinate speed, 'man' without stature or complexion.
- Locke's triangle is quoted verbatim at Intro Sec.13 and declared self-contradictory.

THE POSITIVE ACCOUNT

- Intro Sec.12: an idea is general by being made to represent or stand for all other particular ideas of the same sort.
- The geometer draws this black inch-long line and proves a theorem about all lines.
- Intro Sec.19-20: language also raises passion, prompts action and disposes the mind.

LIMITS TO STATE YOURSELF

- The argument works only against an IMAGISTIC reading of ideas.
- UNPAID BILL: what fixes the RESPECT under which a particular idea represents its class?

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because material substance in general is itself an abstract general idea, the collapse of abstraction removes matter by itself.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Berkeley's immaterialism rests on his nominalism and not the reverse, which is why the Introduction precedes the metaphysics.

12

STAGE 12

THE FIVE ARGUMENTS FOR IMMATERIALISM AND THEIR PRESUPPOSITIONS

SEMANTIC Sec.1-4
LIKENESS Sec.8
PARITY Sec.9-15
MASTER Sec.22-23
CONTINUITY Sec.30-33
ESSE EST PERCIPI Sec.3

SENSIBLE THING = WHAT IS IMMEDIATELY PERCEIVED BY SENSE

SEMANTIC and LIKENESS remove the represented material original → PARITY removes the last quality matter might have owned → MASTER blocks the intuitive rejoinder about the unperceived tree

THE FIVE, NAMED

- SEMANTIC: sensible things are collections of immediately perceived ideas, so their esse is percipi.
- LIKENESS: an idea can be like nothing but an idea, and an unverifiable resemblance is empty.
- PARITY: Locke's own relativity considerations apply to primary qualities too.
- MASTER: you cannot conceive an unconceived body. CONTINUITY: inert ideas need an active infinite spirit.

PRESUPPOSITIONS AND OBJECTIONS

- The identification at step three is a DEFINITION, not a discovery.
- Relativity does not entail mind-dependence; isomorphism answers the likeness principle.
- MASTER ARGUMENT: a scope or use-mention confusion, per Russell and refined by Prior and Gallois.

WHAT IS DELETED AND WHAT IS KEPT

- DELETED: material substance as an unthinking, unperceivable substratum.
- KEPT: tables and chairs as collections of ideas, natural law, science, other minds and God.
- PROVENANCE: 'esse est percipi aut percipere' is a later commentators' expansion, never Berkeley's Latin.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Naming five distinct arguments where the average script asserts one Latin tag is the largest differentiator on this sub-topic.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: To be is to be perceived is a conclusion reached five different ways, not a slogan that can be asserted and left standing.

13

STAGE 13

SPIRITS, NOTIONS, GOD AND THE CONTINUITY OF THE UNPERCEIVED

IDEAS ARE PASSIVE
SPIRITS ARE ACTIVE
KNOWN BY NOTION
LAWS AS SIGNS
GOD SUSTAINS CONTINUITY
ANALOGY FOR OTHER MINDS
AD HOC CHARGE

THE DERIVATION OF GOD

- Ideas are passive and inert, so they cannot cause anything.
- Sense-ideas nevertheless arrive involuntarily in a steady, regular order.
- Only spirits act, so an infinite spirit of greater power and wisdom produces them and sustains them unperceived.

THE NOTION DOCTRINE

- Sec.27, 89, 140: spirits and relations are known by NOTION, not by idea.
- REASON: a passive idea could never picture an active spirit, so the asymmetry is forced rather than chosen.
- CRITICS: an unperceivable spirit repeats the fault Berkeley found in an unknowable substratum.

SCIENCE, ILLUSION AND OTHER MINDS

- Natural laws are the settled grammar of a divine language, so regularities are signs and not causes.
- Illusion is an error of JUDGMENT about what further ideas will follow, not about existence.
- Other finite spirits are inferred by ANALOGY from purposive signs, which blocks crude solipsism.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — God performs precisely the two functions Locke assigned to matter, so immaterialism substitutes posits rather than eliminating them.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Berkeley keeps the self as an active spirit while Hume will not, and that single contrast organises the whole Self and God limb.

14

STAGE 14

THE TWO ROUTED COMPARISONS: MOORE, RUSSELL AND HEGEL ON MATCHED AXES

ACT-OBJECT DISTINCTION
TRANSPARENCY
LOGICAL CONSTRUCTION
STRUCTURAL OBJECTIVITY
SUBJECTIVE IDEALISM
ABSOLUTE IDEALISM
DIFFERENT IN KIND

AXIS	MOORE	RUSSELL	HEGEL
CORE MOVE	the act of awareness is not its object	objects are built from sense-data and relations	objectivity is a moment of self-developing Spirit
RESULT	direct realism about the ordinary object	logical construction with structural objectivity	absolute idealism, not a perceiver's idealism
RELATION TO BERKELEY	rejects the inference from experienced to dependent	rejects the ontology and rebuilds it analytically	differs in kind, not in degree

THE 2018 THIRD LIMB

- Moore DEFENDS the ordinary object as directly known; Russell REPLACES it with a construction.
- Shared ground: both refuse to reduce the object to the act or to the idea.
- Moore restores common sense; Russell restores science.

THE 2024 SECOND LIMB

- Berkeley: reality is ideas in finite and divine minds, and God is an infinite PERCEIVER.
- Hegel: reality is the self-development of Absolute Spirit through determinate negation.
- 'Berkeley the early Hegel' is a category error the paper is designed to detect.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Both routed comparisons are lost by scripts that write parallel mini-essays instead of running one axis across the systems.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Announce the axis first and the comparison writes itself, because every later difference becomes a consequence of one decision.

15

STAGE 15

HUME'S INSTRUMENT: IMPRESSIONS, THE COPY PRINCIPLE, ASSOCIATION AND THE FORK

FORCE AND VIVACITY
COPY PRINCIPLE
MISSING SHADE OF BLUE
RESEMBLANCE CONTIGUITY CAUSATION
RELATIONS OF IDEAS
MATTERS OF FACT
COMMIT IT TO THE FLAMES

PERCEPTIONS divide into IMPRESSIONS and IDEAS by force and vivacity → COPY PRINCIPLE demands a simple impression for every simple idea → ASSOCIATION supplies resemblance, contiguity and cause and effect → THE FORK sorts all enquiry into relations of ideas and matters of fact

THE INSTRUMENT

- Perceptions divide into vivid IMPRESSIONS and their faint IDEAS, distinguished by force and vivacity.
- Every SIMPLE idea derives from a corresponding SIMPLE impression; a missing source makes the idea suspect or fictitious.
- Association connects ideas by RESEMBLANCE, CONTIGUITY and CAUSE AND EFFECT - psychological, not logical.

THE CONCEDED EXCEPTION

- Treatise I.i.1 and Enquiry II: the missing shade of blue is a simple idea with no antecedent impression.
- It shows the copy principle is an EMPIRICAL GENERALISATION, not an analytic truth.
- REPLY: interpolation between impressions actually had preserves the principle's spirit if not its letter.

THE FORK

- RELATIONS OF IDEAS: a priori, necessary, denial self-contradictory - '2+2=4'.
- MATTERS OF FACT: a posteriori, contingent, contrary always conceivable - 'the sun will rise tomorrow'.
- Neither? Then commit it to the flames (Enquiry XII), aimed at divinity or school metaphysics.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — One instrument is applied three times, so substance, the self and necessary connexion fall by a single argumentative move.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Name the idea, demand its impression, and reclassify what cannot be produced - that audit is the whole of Hume's destructive method.

16

STAGE 16

SUBSTANCE DISSOLVED AND THE BELIEF IN CONTINUED AND DISTINCT BODIES

NO IMPRESSION OF A BEARER
FICTION OF THE IMAGINATION
MATERIAL AND SPIRITUAL ALIKE
CONSTANCY
COHERENCE
DOUBLE EXISTENCE UNVERIFIABLE

THE DISSOLUTION

- Impressions deliver redness, hardness and sweetness, never the bearer of those qualities.
- So 'substance' is a fiction produced by grouping constantly conjoined qualities and inventing a support.
- This dissolves MATERIAL and SPIRITUAL substance alike, which is where Hume passes Berkeley.

THE BELIEF IN BODY

- Treatise I.iv.2: sense presents only interrupted perceptions, never continued or distinct existence.
- CONSTANCY and COHERENCE lead the imagination to feign continued objects and smooth the gaps.
- The philosophers' double-existence theory cannot be verified, since all comparison stays within perceptions.

THE PATTERN OF HUMEAN NATURALISM

- Hume does NOT demonstrate that no external world exists.
- Sceptical reflection removes the rational justification; nature restores the belief in ordinary life.
- Explain psychological inevitability AFTER showing that reason cannot reach the metaphysical object.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Reason is shown to be silent and nature is then shown to be irresistible, which is the shape of every Humean result.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Hume denies the content of the idea of substance rather than the existence of anything, and that precision protects the whole answer.

17

STAGE 17

THE BUNDLE SELF, THE APPENDIX RETRACTION AND KANT'S APPERCEPTION

NO CONSTANT IMPRESSION
PERPETUAL FLUX
BUNDLE OR COLLECTION
FICTION BY RESEMBLANCE AND CAUSATION
ALL MY HOPES VANISH
THE I THINK
FORMAL CONDITION

APPLY THE COPY PRINCIPLE TO THE PERCEIVER → INTROSPECTION finds only particular perceptions in perpetual flux → THEREFORE the self is a bundle, and its unity is a fiction → APPENDIX: no principle of union can be stated → KANT: a formal condition of unified experience, not a discovered entity

THE DOCTRINE

- Treatise I.iv.6: the self is nothing but a bundle or collection of different perceptions in perpetual flux.
- DENIED: a simple identical self-substance. NOT DENIED: the perceptions, which are entirely real.
- Unity is a fiction produced when resemblance and causation let the imagination mistake an easy transition for an identical object.

THE CONFESSION

- The Appendix: all my hopes vanish when I come to explain the principles that unite our successive perceptions.
- Having denied both substance and real connexion, no resource for a uniting principle remains.
- The Enquiry silently drops personal identity altogether.

KANT'S REPLY, STATED EXACTLY

- Kant ACCEPTS that no intuition reveals a simple soul-substance; he is not restoring a Cartesian ego.
- The 'I think' must be able to accompany all representations if they are to belong to one experience.
- Transcendental unity of apperception is a FORMAL CONDITION, and the Humean may answer that a condition of description is not an entity.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The failure to state a uniting principle indicts the atomism of impressions rather than the self it was meant to explain.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Hume finds the perceptions and loses the owner, and his own Appendix is the strongest evidence about where the fault lies.

18

STAGE 18

CAUSATION: THE NEGATIVE ARGUMENT AND THE TWO DEFINITIONS OF CAUSE

PRIORITY CONTIGUITY CONJUNCTION
NO IMPRESSION OF POWER
INTERNAL SEARCH FAILS
IMPRESSION OF REFLECTION
CUSTOM OR HABIT
TWO DEFINITIONS
BILLIARD BALLS AND BREAD

DEMAND THE IMPRESSION OF NECESSARY CONNEXION → EXTERNAL SEARCH yields priority, contiguity and constant conjunction only → INTERNAL SEARCH yields no impression of the will's operation → FOUND: the mind's determination, an impression of reflection → RESULT: two definitions of cause, and custom as the guide of life

WHAT IS AND IS NOT OBSERVED

- OBSERVED: temporal priority, spatial contiguity and constant conjunction across instances.
- NOT OBSERVED: any power or tie; and repetition adds no new quality to the objects themselves.
- INTERNAL SEARCH also fails: no impression of how the will moves a limb, which closes the Cartesian and occasionalist routes.

THE POSITIVE FIND

- Repetition determines THE MIND to pass from the idea of the cause to that of the effect.
- That felt determination is an IMPRESSION OF REFLECTION, and the idea of necessity is copied from it.
- Necessity is something that exists in the mind, not in objects.

THE TWO DEFINITIONS

- PHILOSOPHICAL: an object followed by another, where all similar objects are followed by similar objects.
- NATURAL: an object followed by another, whose appearance CONVEYS THE THOUGHT to the other.
- They pull apart and are never reconciled - the origin of the regularity versus projectivist debate.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Repetition changes the observer rather than the objects, so necessity is relocated instead of being abolished.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Hume never denies causation; he moves its necessity from the collision to the spectator, and naming both definitions proves you know it.

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STAGE 19

INDUCTION AS A FORMAL DILEMMA, KANT'S SECOND ANALOGY AND MITIGATED SCEPTICISM

UNIFORMITY PRINCIPLE
NOT DEMONSTRABLE
NOT PROBABLE
STEP THREE IS THE TARGET
SECOND ANALOGY
SYNTHETIC A PRIORI
MITIGATED NOT PYRRHONIAN

THE DILEMMA

- All factual reasoning beyond sense and memory rests on cause and effect, which rests on the Uniformity Principle.
- NOT DEMONSTRABLE: the course of nature may change without contradiction.
- NOT PROBABLE: every experiential argument already presupposes the principle, so it is circular.

WHERE EVERY REPLY STRIKES

- STEP 3 assumes the exhaustiveness of the demonstrative-or-probable division, which is the fork applied reflexively.
- KANT adds a third category; POPPER denies science needs induction; STRAWSON dissolves the demand.

KANT AND THE POSITIVE DOCTRINE

- SECOND ANALOGY: cause is an a priori rule distinguishing objective event-succession from subjective succession of perceptions.
- 'Every event has a cause' is synthetic a priori for possible experience, with no claim about things in themselves.
- MITIGATED SCEPTICISM: bounded enquiry, belief proportioned to evidence, reliance on natural belief - stable only if natural beliefs are exempt.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Kant is correctly aimed because he attacks the atomism of impressions rather than the inference Hume drew from it.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The scepticism about induction is the shadow cast by Hume's classification of propositions, and survives exactly as long as the fork does.

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STAGE 20

GOD ACROSS THE THREE SYSTEMS AND THE WITHDRAWAL TEST

SUPPORT
MECHANISM
CASUALTY
DESIGN ARGUMENT
FINITE ARCHITECT
MIRACLES

SYSTEM	JOB GOD PERFORMS	IF WITHDRAWN
LOCKE	a demonstrated conclusion and a guarantee of our faculties	the demonstration and the defence of representative realism fall; the epistemology survives
BERKELEY	cause of involuntary ideas and guarantor of continuity	the system collapses: no cause of order, no continuity, no real-imaginary distinction
HUME	none - every proof is examined and rejected	nothing is lost, because nothing rested on him

HUME'S THREE FRONTS

- CAUSAL: no impression of a first cause or of necessary connexion licenses the inference.
- DESIGN: weak analogy; at most a finite architect on given matter; natural order without intelligence; the problem of evil.
- MIRACLES: testimony is always less probable than its own falsehood (Enquiry X).

THE DEEPEST CRITICISM OF IMMATERIALISM

- God performs exactly the two functions Locke assigned to matter: causing our ideas and sustaining the unperceived.
- Berkeley's economy is therefore a substitution of posits rather than an elimination of them.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Dependence on the divine premise runs inversely to the consistency of the empiricism, which is the axis a comparison should announce.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Ask what job God performs in each system and the withdrawal test does the comparative work in a single paragraph.

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STAGE 21

THE EIGHT-AXIS COMPARISON AND THE CRITICISM-REPLY-RESIDUAL LEDGER

MATTER
QUALITIES
SUBSTANCE
SELF
CAUSATION
GOD
SCEPTICISM
RESIDUAL COLUMN

AXIS	LOCKE	BERKELEY	HUME
MATTER	real but an unknowable substrate	does not exist; an empty word	no impression, therefore a fiction
QUALITIES	primary objective, secondary powers	all mind-dependent; the distinction collapses	all are impressions; no objective split
SELF	continuity of consciousness	an active spirit known by notion	a bundle of perceptions in flux
CAUSATION	real power, with limited knowledge	God's will producing ideas in us	constant conjunction plus habit
SCEPTICISM	rejected; moderate realism	claims to refute scepticism	embraced, but mitigated

LEDGER AGAINST LOCKE AND BERKELEY

- Veil objection - REPLY divine non-deception - RESIDUAL an epistemic problem becomes a theological guarantee.
- Circularity of memory - REPLY constitutive versus evidential - RESIDUAL ownership may return.
- Why invoke God - REPLY theism by empiricist means - RESIDUAL God does matter's old job.

LEDGER AGAINST HUME

- Science becomes inexplicable - REPLY inductive habit - RESIDUAL success is not warrant.
- What unites the bundle - REPLY none offered - RESIDUAL the atomism is at fault.
- Is the fork self-refuting - REPLY a meta-level clarification - RESIDUAL that status is contested.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — A criticism without a reply is journalism and a reply without a residual is advocacy, so the third column carries the judgement.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Announce a criterion, run matched axes, then rule - a comparison is an argument about a mechanism and never a gallery of positions.

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STAGE 22

PYQ ROUTES, DIRECTIVES, PROVENANCE, TRAPS AND THE QUALIFIED CONCLUSION

TWELVE ROUTED PARTS
EXPLAIN = DERIVATION
EXAMINE = STATE AND TEST
CRITICALLY ANALYSE = VERDICT
TABULA RASA IS A LABEL
AUT PERCIPERE IS AN EXPANSION
II.xxvii ADDED 1694
RIGOUR, NOT DECADENCE

DECODE THE DIRECTIVE before choosing the structure → STATE THE CRITERION or thesis in the opening line → BUILD the empiricist argument completely before any routed reply → RULE with a verdict scaled to the marks available

PYQ ROUTES BY YEAR

- 2018 Q1(a) fork and conceivability; 2018 Q3(a) five arguments, Moore, Russell and the contrast.
- 2019 Q4(b) not in objects, yes in the mind; 2020 Q2(a) bundle, Appendix, apperception.
- 2021 Q1(c) immediately perceived; Q1(d) person, man, substance; Q1(e) constant conjunction plus felt necessity.
- 2022 Q4(c) three grounds and the degrees; 2023 Q2(a) full analysis and a ruling; 2024 Q2(a) parity, likeness, Hegel; 2025 Q2(c) Hume then Kant; 2025 Q4(c) abstraction and its replacement.

PROVENANCE AND TRAPS

- Locke writes 'white paper, void of all characters'; the Essay appeared in 1689 with 1690 on the title page.
- Berkeley's Latin at Sec.3 is esse est percipi; the Treatise and the Enquiry must never be merged.
- Never write that Berkeley denies the external world or that Hume denies causation.

QUALIFIED CONCLUSION

- Empiricism consistently applied ends in a scepticism nobody can live.
- That outcome diagnoses the founding rule as INCOMPLETE rather than refuting philosophy.
- Kant keeps the negative results and attacks the atomism that produced them, so the slide is rigour and not decadence.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The examinable spine is a criterion, a mechanism and a graded verdict, and each directive fixes which of the three dominates.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Close by naming the load-bearing premise rather than summarising, because the mark is awarded for the diagnosis and not the coverage.

E

EXTRA

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - ENRICHMENT ONLY, NEVER A CORE PREREQUISITE

REAL ESSENCE DEBATE
MASTER ARGUMENT READINGS
SCEPTIC OR NATURALIST
STATUS OF THE FORK
MODALITY OF THE COPY PRINCIPLE

LIVE INTERPRETIVE DISPUTES

- Is Locke's substratum a humble realist posit or an empty placeholder?
- Does the Master Argument prove anything beyond a scope confusion?
- Is Hume better read as a destructive sceptic or as a naturalist?

SAFE USE

- One evaluative rider inside a fifteen- or twenty-mark answer, after the core doctrine is secure.
- Never present any of these readings as settled doctrine.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This stage is enrichment and is unnecessary for a competent core answer to any of the twelve routed questions.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels